1963

1 December: The Naga Hills become Nagaland, an Indian state, but the insurgency continues.

1964

27 May: Nehru dies a broken man embittered by what he saw as a Chinese betrayal.

August: Chinese troops intrude into Nathu La in Sikkim, followed by more incursions in December.

October 16: China conducts its first nuclear test.

1965

April: Skirmishes between Pakistan and India lead to war between the two countries in August. Pakistan is defeated and moves closer to China.

1966

24 January: Indira Gandhi becomes India's prime minister and strengthens the country's relationship with the Soviet Union.

26 February: A rebellion breaks out among the Mizos on India's border with Myanmar.

16 May: Mao launches his 'Great Proletarian Cultural Revolution' to purge any remaining opponents to his rule.

20 September: Chinese troops open fire on Indian soldiers on the border with Sikkim.

24 October: The first batch of Naga rebels sets off from India on foot through northern Myanmar to China.

1967

27 January: The first batch of Naga rebels reaches China. They are followed by many more Nagas as well as rebels from Mizoram and Manipur.

May: A Maoist-inspired peasant uprising breaks out in Naxalbari in northern West Bengal.

1968